CLASSIFIED

FILE REF: ZYT-1192-001

TEMPLOS

ZEYTİNLİK

AIDA · ELEONORA
MADINA · ADELYA

35.3389° N · 33.3147° E

PLACE BRAND





BRAND INTRODUCTION



ZEYTINLIK (TEMPLOS / TEMROS)

OVERVIEW

This project develops a place brand for Zeytinlik, a village in the Kyrenia District of North Cyprus. Rather than treating the village as a tourism product, the project approaches it as a place with accumulated memory. Naming history, physical traces, local stories, and cultural continuity form the foundation of the brand.

Region: Kyrenia District, TRNC
Population: ~1,090

Distance to St Hilarion: 3km
Walkable village scale



WHY THIS PLACE MATTERS



Name archive: Templos / Temros → Zeytinlik



Material identity: olive/oil as an economic and cultural base



Monument olive: strong landmark (900-year narrative)



Water heritage: su kemeri (aqueduct) + well and drought stories



Legend codes: Yüzbirevler (101 rooms / 40 years)



Garip Dede (legend + modern public debate)



Writers' memory: Ali Nesim + Haşmet Muzaffer Gürkan public commemoration



Real daily-life nodes: village square + well, mosque, stone park, cafés, restaurants, stays

NAMING HISTORY

One of the strongest identity features of Zeytinlik is its naming history.

The village carries three names across time: Templos, Temros or Temroz, and Zeytinlik.
They preserve different historical and cultural layers.

PRIMARY

TEMPLOS

Historical recorded name associated with the older history of the settlement.

TEMROS

Oral and community-based phonetic form preserved through everyday use.

ZEYTINLIK

Official contemporary name linked to olive heritage and continuity of place identity.

HISTORICAL & CULTURAL RESEARCH



LUSIGNAN PERIOD

Templos was historically linked to the Knights Templar and may have served as a supply point on the route to Saint Hilarion Castle. In 1975, it was renamed Zeytinlik, meaning “olive orchard.”



MEMORY KEEPERS

Ali Nesim (1941–2014) helped create the Olive Festival and protected Zeytinlik’s olive trees. Haşmet Muzaffer Gürkan (1932–2003) preserved the history and traditions of Zeytinlik. Their cultural legacy is still honored through tributes in the olive grove.



MYTH

VisitNCY’s Myths & Legends states that in Zeytinlik (Templos), St. Hilarion is known as Yüzbirevler and is believed to have 101 rooms. The legend includes Wish Day, a rare opening every 40 years, and a moral about greed and time.



LEGEND

Garip Dede is a local legend about a white-bearded dervish who revealed water beneath a tree, leading to a well and a site linked to the tree, well, and tomb. The story also carries a moral about honesty.

CULTURAL AND SOCIAL RESEARCH



Olive Heritage

Zeytinlik village is known for its olive trees, which hold cultural, spiritual, and economic value in Cyprus, including one believed to be around 900 years old.

According to legend, Jesus Christ hid in an olive tree and blessed it with long life, abundance, and protection. Today, olive trees remain a symbol of prosperity and protection in Zeytinlik.



Olive Festival

The Zeytinlik Olive Festival is an annual event celebrating the village's olive-growing tradition through food, crafts, music, and local activities. Started around 2001 by Girne

Municipality, it helps preserve and promote Zeytinlik's olive culture and products. For branding, it is valuable because it gives the village visibility and highlights its identity and local products.

KEY HERITAGE POINTS



SPECIMEN 0001

900-Year Olive

A living witness of continuity, damage, and survival.



OBJECT 0004

Stone Arch

A real architectural threshold that later informed the visual identity system.



PLACE 0089

Square

A small-scale public centre where everyday life and local memory overlap.



OBJECT 0002

Well

A spatial and narrative centre linked to water heritage and the story of Garip Dede.



CASE 0047

Poets' Park

A site where cultural memory becomes visible and embodied.

BRAND ESSENCE

The place that remembers and shares with those who listen.

Brand Essence layers and how are they represented:

900-year Olive Tree	Got burned inside, yet continues to bear fruit for 900 years	The embodiment of memories that survive a global-level catastrophe
Legend Narrative	The older of 2 brothers gets trapped asleep in the castle for 40 years due to his greed. Unfortunately his memory has gone once he comes out and meets a younger brother that has outgrown him.	The legend emphasizes the importance of preserving, respect, balance. Intensifying the sadness of lost memories it additionally encourages to prioritize values and wisdom of the right choice.
Village's Names	The Village gets renamed multiple times before the modern name. Templos → Temros → Zeytinlik.	Every renaming is a layer of a preserved memory, rather than a loss.

BRAND ARCHETYPE

SAGE

A Sage according to the definition is a character who seeks knowledge, truth, helps others with their wisdom and is extremely powerful in a variety of forms like magic, wealth, influence etc.

WHY SAGE?

Sage is a suitable embodiment of the legend's main character (younger brother) which is also rooted, inspired from the village itself. Ali Nesim, 900 year fruiting Olive tree, 101 rooms treasure myth: everything is pointing to the Sage archetype of a caring, trustworthy, knowledgeable and memorable, giving place.

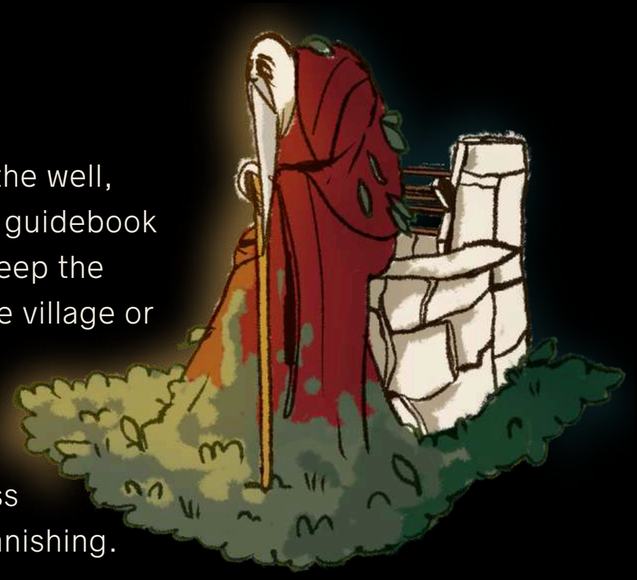
BRAND SLOGAN

The past is still present.

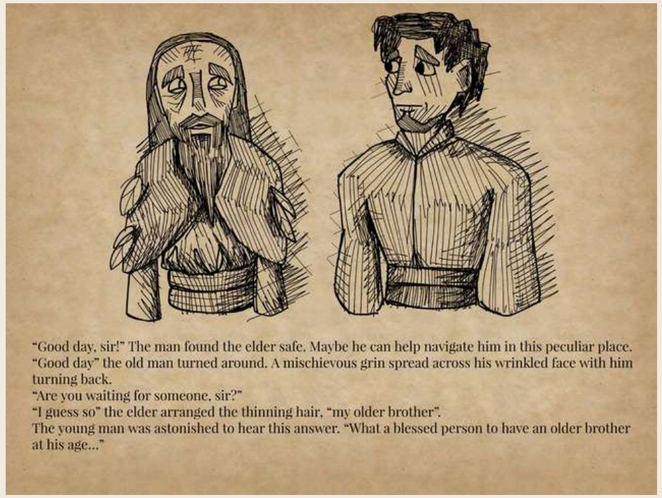
Some places remember.

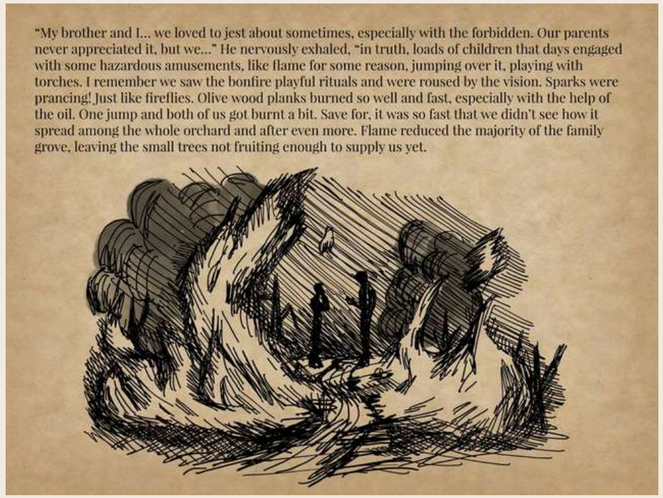
BRAND PERSONA

Brand persona is an elder sitting on the well, which is aware of stories not a single guidebook can describe. The core desire is to keep the knowledge even after renaming of the village or deaths of poets and writers. His tone is slow and calm, he is a witness of various plots that have happened here. Core fear might be a history loss or a simplification with the identity vanishing.



BRAND STORY





LEGEND NARRATIVE CORE

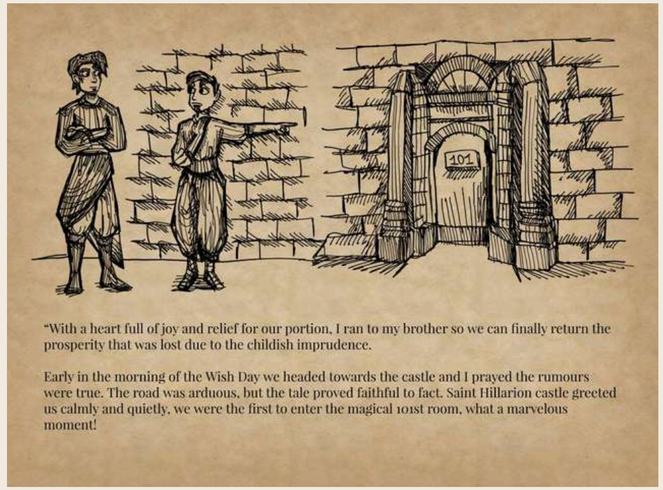
Exposition:
The legend is structured in the format of a story within a story. A young man feeling dizzy and lost approaches an elder sitting near the castle, who is waiting to meet his brother after a long parting. An elder later begins to tell a story of their 40-year separation.

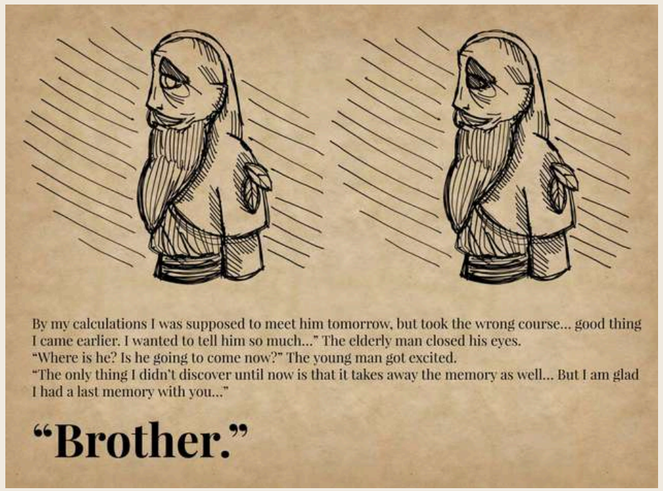
Story Setup:
According to the elder, he and his brother managed to burn their prosperous Olive gardens. The only survived one was a 900 year old, yet it got burned inside. Parents in rage sent their children to earn money that they lost by their silliness. After a time of a low-paid job, the elder which was a younger brother heard a story from the man in the bazaar. The legend about a St Hillarion Castle's Wish day, where once in 40 years the room 101 opens to give a single treasure for those that enter.

Climax:
Both brothers were happy about these news, however an older brother got blinded by his greed grabbing more than allowed. The wrong choice got him trapped in the castle, while the other was left outside.

Plot Twist:
At the end the young man listening to the story turned out to be an older brother of the elder, that didn't age and got his memories gone because of the castle's spell.
Legend focuses on the importance of remembering, right values and choice with wisdom.

BRAND STORY





LINK TO REALITY

FACTS THAT WERE USED IN OUR LEGEND WRITING:

- St Hillarion Castle actually exists 3 km from the village (35.3266° N, 33.2878° E). Commonly called as Yüzbirevler, which means "One Hundred and One Rooms".
- VisitNCY, «Myths & Legends of North Cyprus»: actual myth about the treasures of 101 room
- 900 year old Olive tree is located in Zeytinlik village and can be visited by anyone nearby.
- The island did face an actual fire in 1192. It didnt burn all the Olive trees, but many got damaged.
- Garip Dede was a prototype for the main character. The same archetype, local legend: The dervish who has found water under a tree.

MEANINGS AND INTERPRETATIONS:

- Greed vs. wisdom: take only what you need.
- The real loss isn't the material loss, but loss of people, connections or time.
- The moral code is directly reflected in brand values: wisdom, justice, memory.

TARGET AUDIENCE — WHO THIS PLACE IS FOR

PRIMARY

The Local Who Doesn't Know

Cypriot / TRNC resident. Drives past Zeytinlik 100 times a year. Has never stopped. Thinks it's 'just a village'. The brand makes them wrong and curious.

"I've been there — nothing special there."

SECONDARY

The Historian / Enthusiast

Researcher or heritage lover. Knows about the Templars and Templos. Demands verifiable sources. Cannot tolerate tourist mythology.

"Show me the document, not the legend."

TERTIARY

Diaspora

London, Berlin, Istanbul. Looking for Cyprus, which is treasured in memory.

"This is the Cyprus I want to pass on to my children."

MISSION

Protect and share the value of Zeytinlik

We transform its legends, history, and cultural layers into a clear and structured story.
This helps visitors understand the place, respect its boundaries, and value its heritage in a thoughtful and balanced way.

VISION

Zeytinlik becomes a place where culture and history are experienced in a calm and balanced way

A place where people come to slow down, learn something real,and respect local life.

PURPOSE

We exist to keep the spirit of Zeytinlik alive

We help people connect with its unique atmosphere, while protecting what makes the village real and authentic. Because if stories and memory are not shared, they disappear.

LOGO

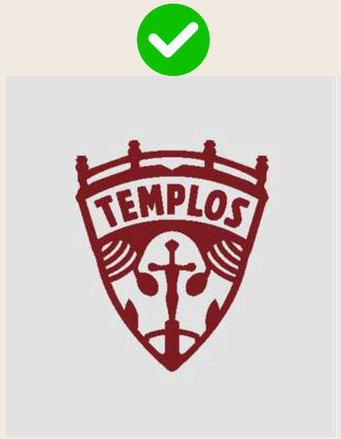
The logo is inspired by the Templos historical layer and the idea of protection.

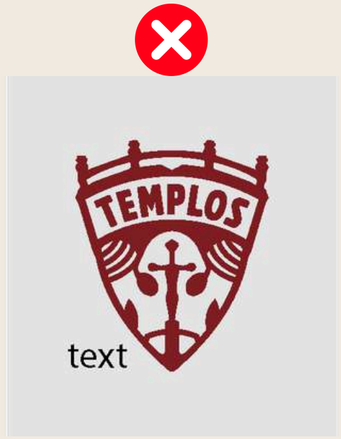
The shield form, arch structure, and sword-like central element connect the brand to the Templar reference, gateway architecture, and the protection of local memory. Olive and leave elements are included as well, highlighting other essential part of the village's persona, which is a splendid, rich and perennial nature.

Besides, the design displays two faces, referencing the important identities of Zeytinlik village: Haşmet Muzaffer Gürkan and Ali Nesim, who were also used as prototypes to the brand story legend (A tale of 2 brothers).



LOGO USAGE





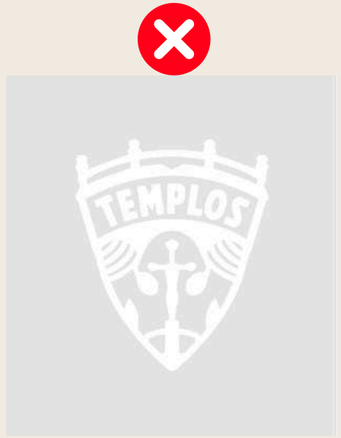
Do not lock up text close to the logo



Do not use colors outside of the brand palette



Do not rearrange elemants of the logos components



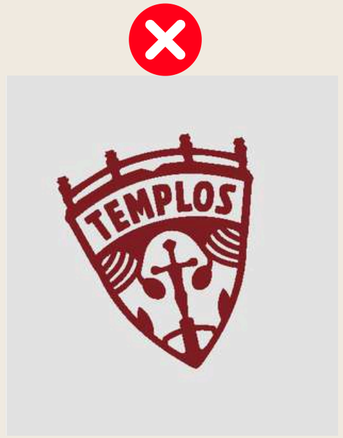
Do not use white logo on light background



Do not place the logo in a holding shape



Do not use dark logo on dark background



Do not rotate the logo

15 / Visual Identity

Charcoal Black

#1C1A1A

Primary / Base

Bone / Parchment

#F0EAE0

Background

Burnt Olive

#5E6650

Living layer

Oxidized Rust

#9A4A38

Accent / Dividers

Signal Red

#B22E2E

Dates only

TYPOGRAPHY

Headlines — Alegreya Sans

Body — Alegreya Sans

Codes — Typedeer Mono

TEMPLOS / ZEYTİNLİK

The tree is 900 years old. It was here before the castle.

SPECIMEN · 0001 · 35.3389° N · STATUS: ACTIVE

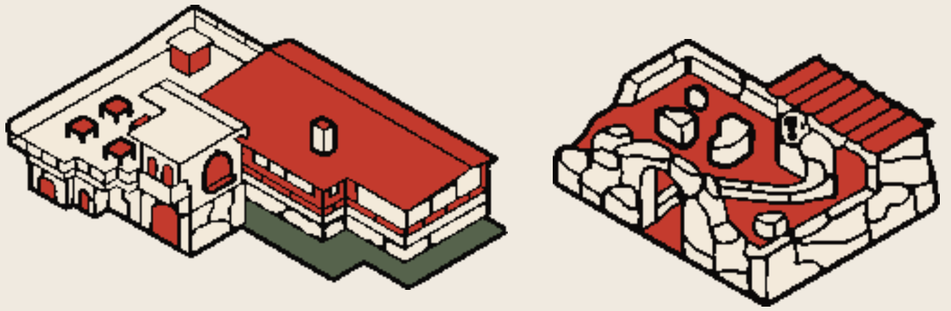
ILLUSTRATION STYLE

Illustration style was intended to look like **engravings and ink**, representing the village's historical depth and traditions.

Combined with the manuscript texture, ink-style illustrations remind of ancient times, human presence, love to the poetry, writing and crafting.

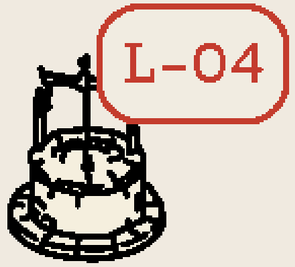
Archival drawings in historical documents, legends and myths contained the similar approach, while the only detail we added was brighter colors supporting our visual identity. The green color of our visual identity represents the continuity of nature, olive trees' fruitfulness and prosperity throughout hundreds of years.

As it can be observed, it is mostly implied in the green ground, trees and leaves. The red color adds the passionate accent, emphasizing the courage nature of knights, heroes and their emotional weight. Mostly seen in the building designs of base locations, highlighting the main heritage points.











WAYFINDING SYSTEM

The wayfinding system helps visitors understand where they are, where they can go, and how to move respectfully through the village.

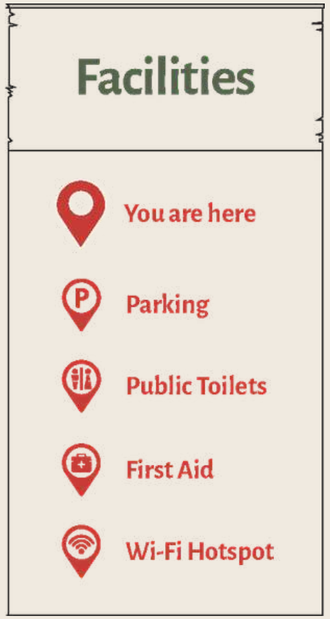
L — Landmark / Legend Points
Historical, cultural, or story-based places.

K — Key Places
Cafés, restaurants, guest houses, and local village places.

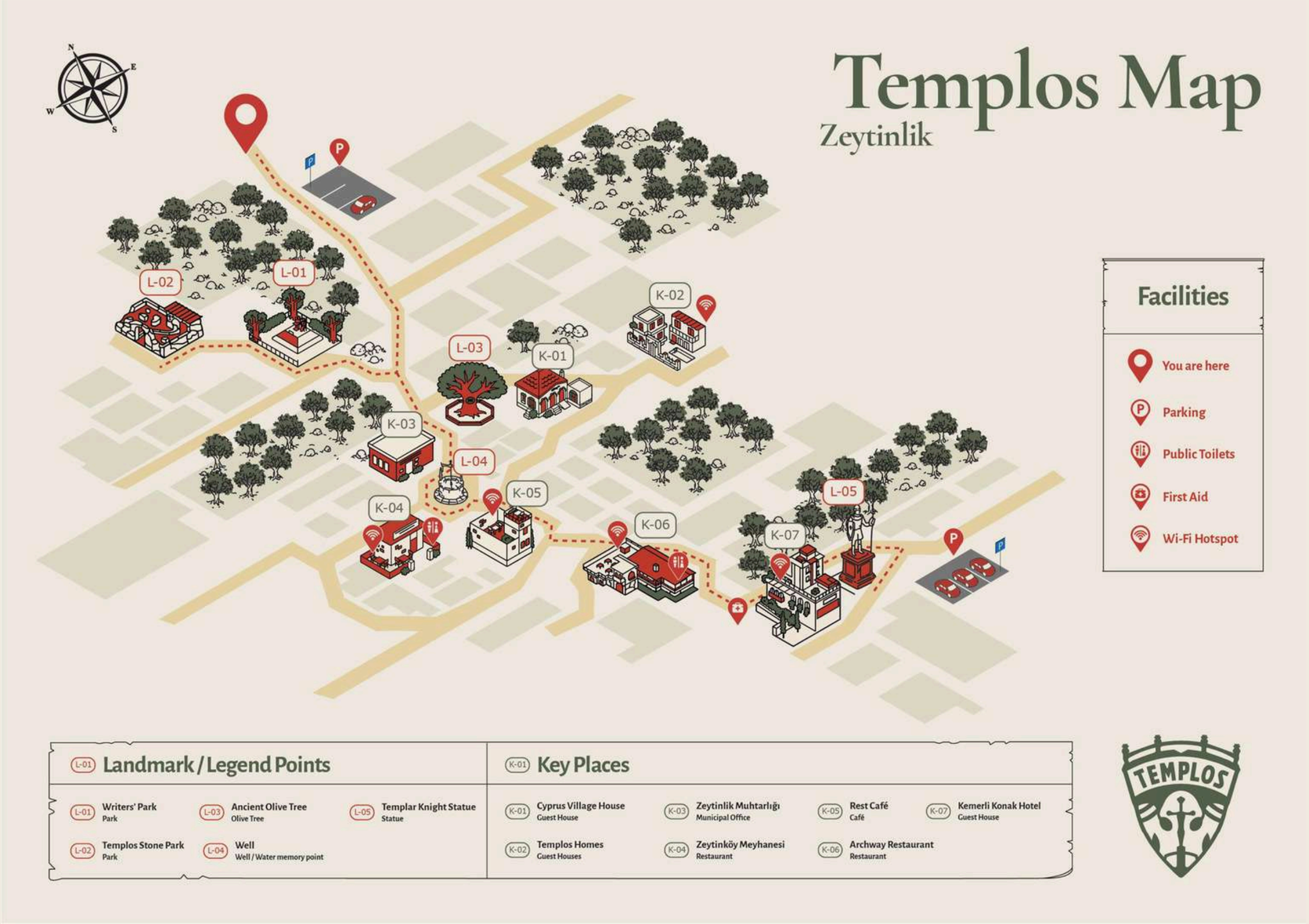
Facilities
Parking, public toilets, first aid, and Wi-Fi hotspot.

The system separates heritage points, everyday places, and practical services to keep the visitor experience clear.





Entrance → Parking → Orientation Board → Memory Trail → Landmarks / Key Places → Return


Templos Map
Zeytinlik
N
E
S
W
L-01
L-02
L-03
L-04
L-05
K-01
K-02
K-03
K-04
K-05
K-06
K-07
Facilities
You are here
Parking
Public Toilets
First Aid
Wi-Fi Hotspot
L-01 Landmark / Legend Points
L-01 Writers' Park Park
L-02 Templos Stone Park Park
L-03 Ancient Olive Tree Olive Tree
L-04 Well Well / Water memory point
L-05 Templar Knight Statue Statue
K-01 Key Places
K-01 Cyprus Village House Guest House
K-02 Templos Homes Guest Houses
K-03 Zeytinlik Muhtarlığı Municipal Office
K-04 Zeytinköy Meyhanesi Restaurant
K-05 Rest Café Café
K-06 Archway Restaurant Restaurant
K-07 Kemerli Konak Hotel Guest House
TEMPLOS

Templos Map

Zeytinlik





SIGNS



GATEWAY SIGN
A main entrance sign marking the arrival into Zeytinlik / Templos.



ORIENTATION MAP BOARD
A large orientation board placed near the parking area, helping visitors understand the route, landmarks, key places, facilities, and the story of Zeytinlik.



PARKING AREA SIGN
A directional sign guiding visitors to the parking area on the Templos / Zeytinlik territory.



BASE LOCATION SIGN
Interprets the important location of Zeytinlik village, heritage feature



PROTECTION SIGN
Prevent damage to the local heritage, educate visitors about why a place or object is important.



RESPECT SIGN
A sign mounted at each residential house in Zeytinlik, reminding visitors to respect the privacy and comfort of local residents.



ROUTE MARKER
Located on long stretches of road where the visitor may be unsure.



WAYFINDING SIGN
An outdoor directional sign for public spaces, guiding visitors to key facilities.

ROUTE MARKER
Located on long stretches of road where the visitor may be unsure.



BASE LOCATION SIGN
Interprets the important location of Zeytinlik village, a landmark for tourists to visit.



DIRECTIONAL SIGN
A directional sign placed at route splits to guide visitors toward landmarks, cafés, parking, and facilities.

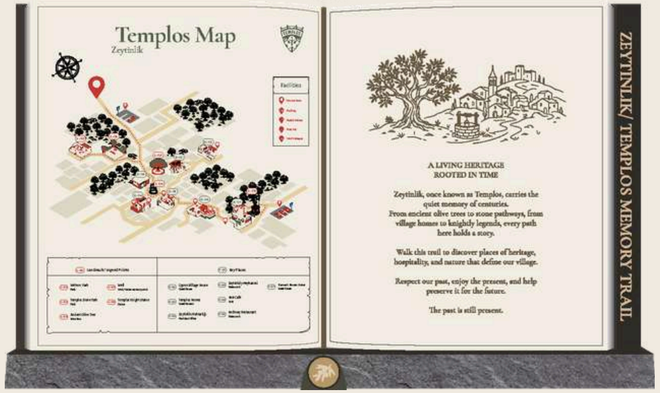
SIGNAGE SYSTEM OVERVIEW

Signage system demonstrate the unified style, representing our main design ideas and vision of Zeytinlik Village.
The purpose is to keep the historical heritage, cultural code, protect local landmarks and educate the people about the places they maintain.
Due to the fact of the place being strongly connected to the Medieval aesthetic, legends, knights we came up with 2 ways of constructing the signage system design, which are:

1) Manuscript scrolls/Paper imitating signs
The embodiment of the actual knowledge, stories, records the village is keeping and passing through the time, signage in the form of scrolls was a first idea to launch especially for the base locations. Later on it was implied to respect and hotspots signs to emphasize the calmness and respect to the villagers.





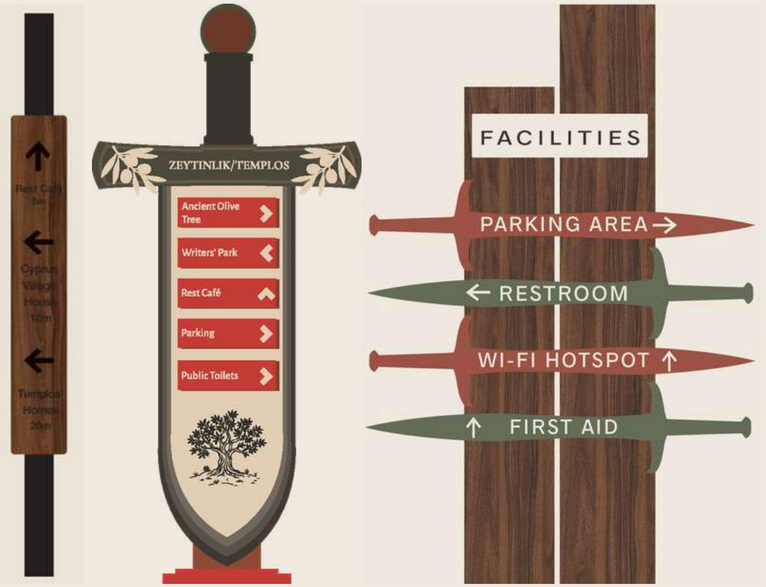


Signage System Overview

2) Sharp/Sword imitating signs

Another approach was mostly implied in the navigating signage, where we aimed to share a symbol of guardianship and security using a form of swords. Zeytinlik's legends sometimes mention heroes, battles, courage and heroism that we tried to demonstrate.

Besides, in both approaches we included the column-like structure and dark wood in the signage referencing the Lusignag period, when Zeytinlik was named Templos/Templar. The visual style references Medieval time period and architecture, limestone foundations and overall construction. Additionally, we wanted to keep the style of the village, compatible with St. Hillarion Castle, historical places and buildings. Olives can be observed as small details in the various signs, as well as tree icons or shapes, reminding to preserve the nature's importance too and referencing the modern name Zeytinlik standing for the "Olive Orchard".





GATEWAY SIGN

Purpose:
A main entrance sign marking the arrival into Zeytinlik / Templos.



Materials:

1) Stone pillars - natural stone texture
2) Main arch panel - dark aged olive metal
3) Lettering - raised cream / bronze metal letters
4) Olive ornaments - 3D metal details on both sides of the arch
5) Pillar plaques - small engraved decorative plates



Locations:

Main entrance road into Zeytinlik
Near the top parking / first arrival point

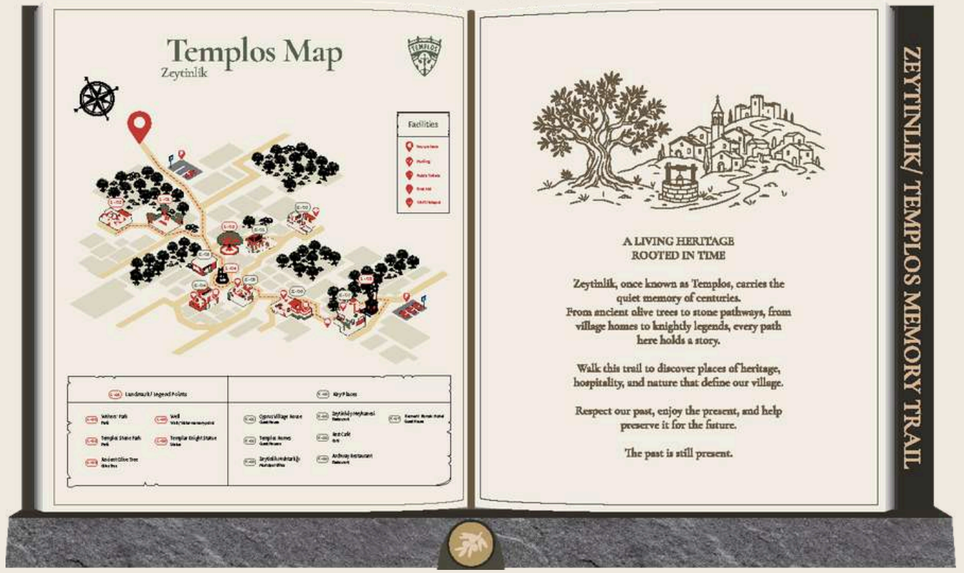
ORIENTATION MAP BOARD

Purpose:
A large orientation board placed near the parking area, helping visitors understand the route, landmarks, key places, facilities, and the story of Zeytinlik.



Materials:

1) Main frame - dark bronze / aged olive metal, shaped as an open book
2) Pages - cream printed panels with protective coating
3) Map page - illustrated map with L / K points, facilities, and “You are here”
4) Story page - heritage illustration and short village text
5) Base - natural stone or dark granite plinth
6) Side spine - vertical “Zeytinlik / Templos Memory Trail” lettering



Locations:

- Main parking area
- Beginning of the walking route
- Optional second board near the bottom-right parking area

DIRECTIONAL SIGN

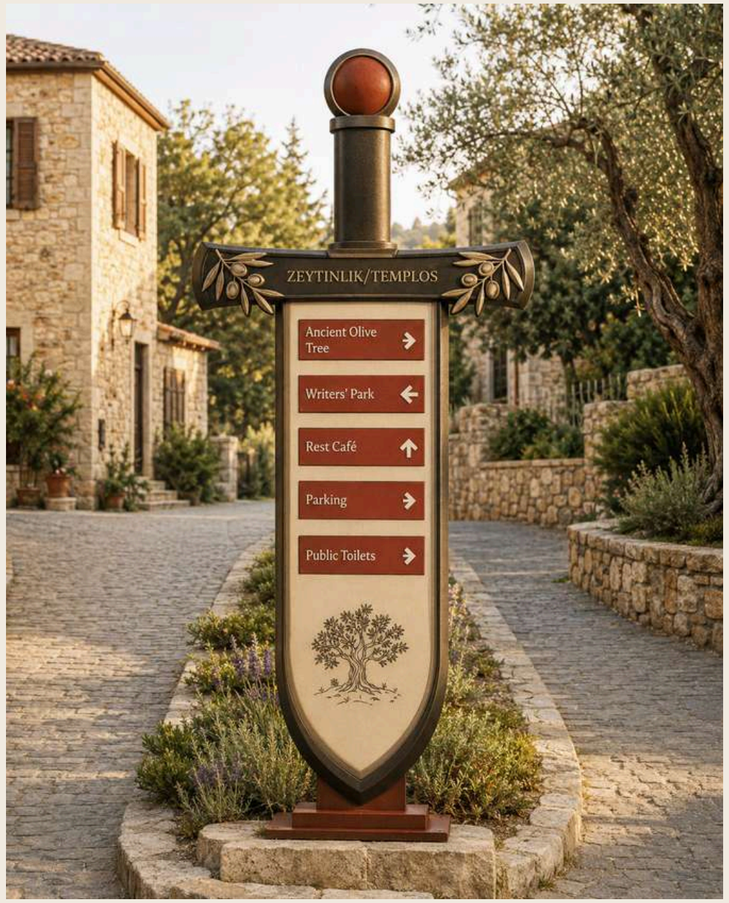
Purpose:
A directional sign placed at route splits to guide visitors toward landmarks, cafés, parking, and facilities. The sword shape refers to the Templos / knight legend.

Materials:

1) Main body - dark aged metal, shaped as a stylized sword
2) Direction panels - terracotta metal plates with cream lettering
3) Arrows - cream / ivory symbols
4) Top plaque - dark metal with “Zeytinlik / Templos”
5) Olive ornaments - 3D metal details
6) Base - corten steel or dark bronze metal plate

Locations:
Near Ancient Olive Tree



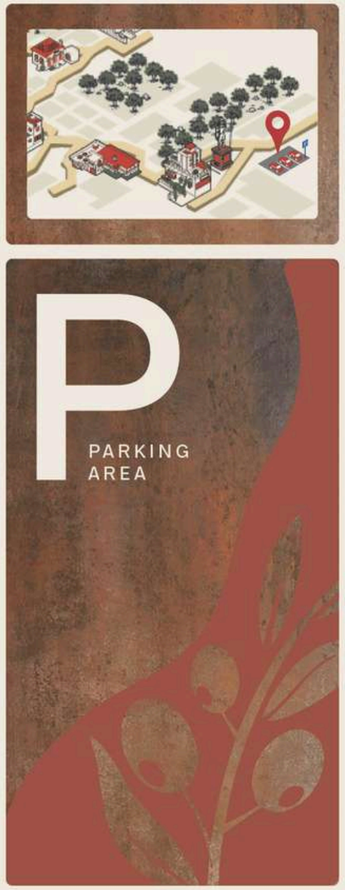


PARKING AREA SIGN

Purpose:
A directional sign guiding visitors to the parking area on the Templos / Zeytinlik territory. Includes an enlarged map fragment showing the current location with a "You are here" marker.

Materials:

1)Corten steel base panel - the main body of the sign, weathered metal
2)Map insert - printed map vinyl placed under a protective glass
3)Olive branch ornament - laser-cut metal, 3D embossed, giving a volumetric sculptural effect on the panel surface





Locations:

1)Top parking - near the main entrance
2)Bottom-right parking - near K-07 (Kemerli Konak Hotel) and L-05 (Templar Knight Statue)

WAYFINDING SIGN "FACILITIES"

Purpose:
An outdoor directional sign for public spaces, guiding visitors to key facilities: Parking Area, Restroom, Wi-Fi Hotspot, and First Aid.

Materials:

1) Post & base - dark aged/weathered wood, assembled frommultiple planks
2) Directional arrows - painted metal, shaped as stylized swords/spearheads in terracotta red and olive green
3) Header plaque - painted wood, cream-colored with dark lettering

Locations:

1) K-04 zone
(Zeytinköy Meyhanesi area)
2) K-06 zone
(Archway Restaurant area)





FACILITY SIGNS

Purpose:
Small individual signs placed directly next to each facility - parking, public toilets, first aid, and Wi-Fi hotspot. Each sign marks the exact location of the facility for visitors.

Materials:

1) Base - dark aged wood post
2) Sign panel - painted wood, cream/ivory color
3) Lettering - dark text on cream background

Locations:

Multiple signs, one at each facility point across the Templos / Zeytinlik territory.













RESPECT SIGN "THIS PLACE IS STILL LIVED IN"

Purpose:
A sign mounted at each residential house in Zeytinlik, reminding visitors to respect the privacy and comfort of local residents. Each sign displays the individual house number



Materials:

1) Base panel - painted metal, dark green
2) Scroll ornament - 3D sculpted metal element shaped as a rolled parchment
3) Lettering - individual 3D raised metal letters fixed onto the scroll surface



Locations:

1) L-03 - Ancient Olive Tree area
2) K-02 - Templos Homes
3) K-04 - Zeytinköy Meyhanesi area
4) K-06 - Archway Restaurant area

BASE LOCATION SIGN LEGEND POINTS

Purpose:
Interprets the important location of Zeytinlik village, a landmark for tourists to visit.

Materials:

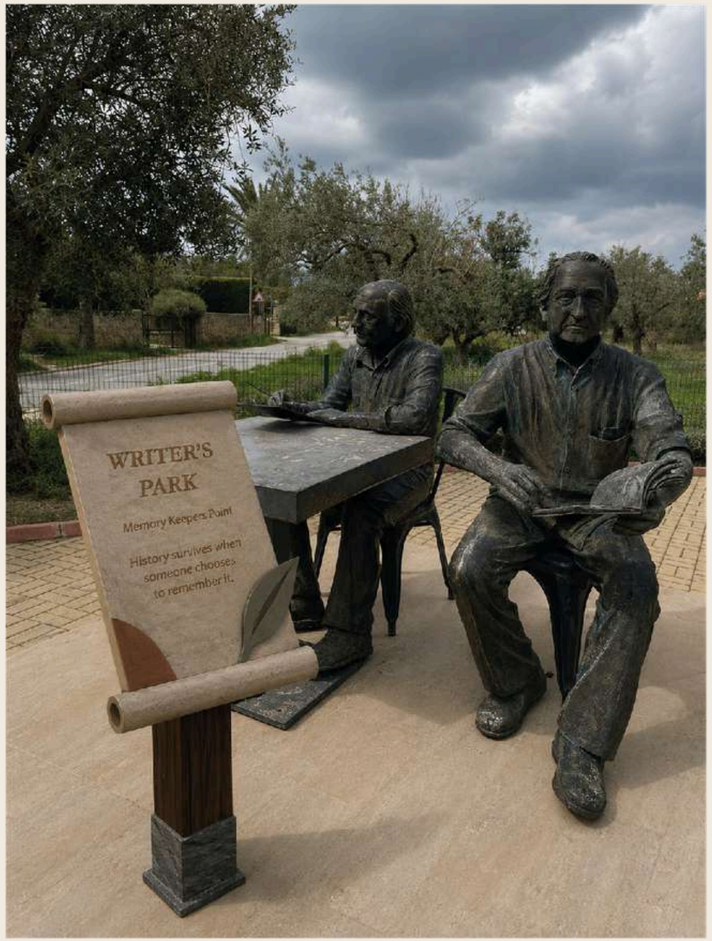
1) Manuscript scroll sign panel and feather- Sandblasted Beige/Green Limestone
2) Vertical Post- dark aged/weathered wood
3) Base Foundation- Concrete with Stone Veneer
4) Text- Engraved lettering filled with brown pigment.

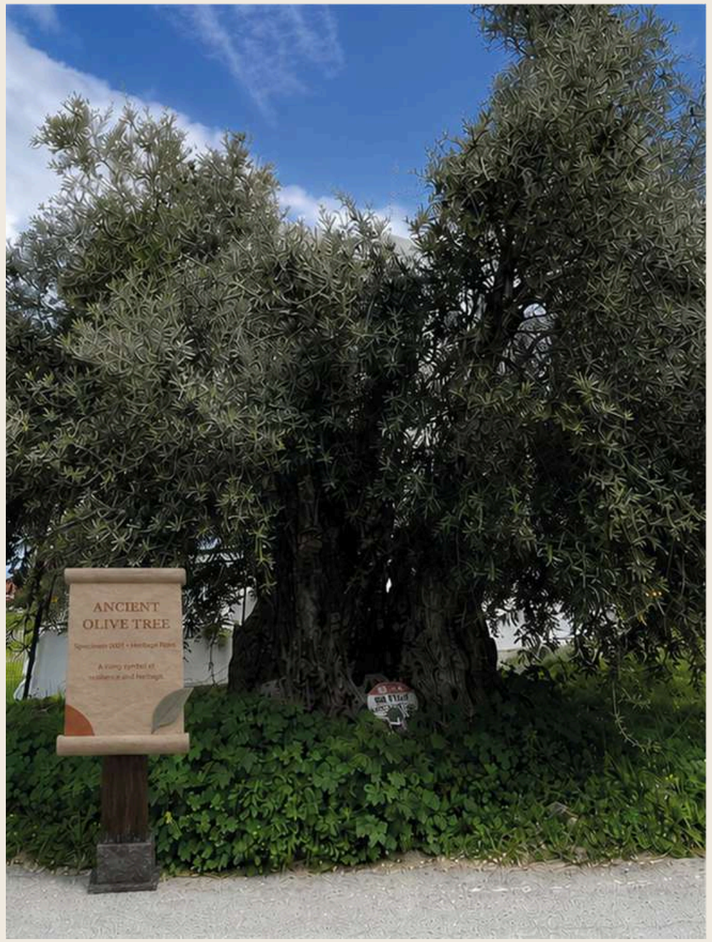


Location:

1) L-01 – Writer's Park
2) L-03 – Ancient Olive Tree
3) L-05 – Templar's Knight Statue

Legend Points AI concepts







BASE LOCATION SIGN WATER MEMORY POINT

Purpose:
Interprets the important location of Zeytinlik village, heritage feature

Materials:

1)Manuscript scroll sign panel- Sandblasted Beige Limestone
2)Vertical Post and horizontal holder of the sign- dark aged/weathered wood
3)Main sign «The Well»- light weathered wood
4) Text- Engraved lettering filled with the beige and brown pigments

Location:

L-04 The Well





PROTECTION SIGN

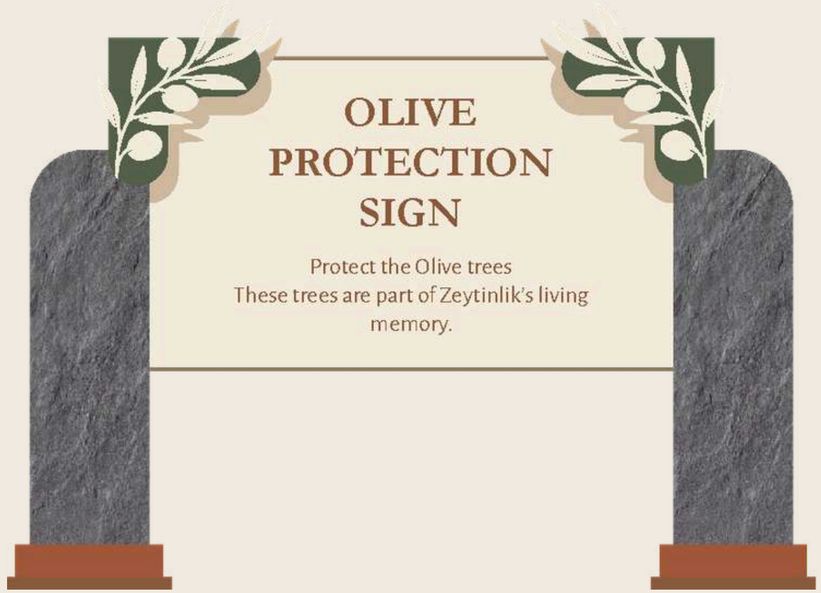
Purpose:
Prevent damage to the local heritage, educate visitors about why a place or object is important.

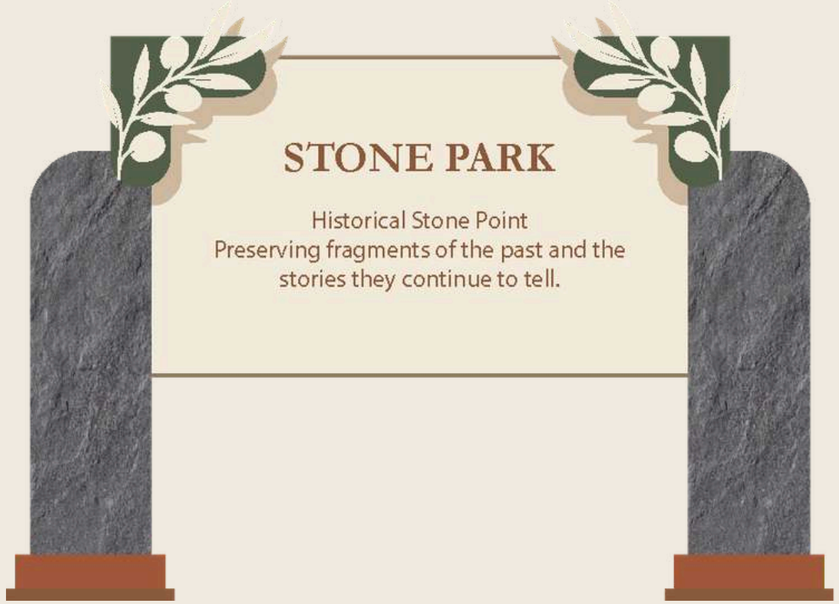
Materials:

1) Parchment sign panel - Sandblasted Light Beige Limestone
2) Base Foundation- Concrete with Stone Veneer and orange weathered wooden stands
3) Olives and leaves- Sandblasted Light Beige and Green Limestone
4) Text- Engraved lettering filled with brown pigment.

Location:

1) L02 – Stone Park2)
2) L-03 Tree park near the Ancient Olive Tree





Protection Signs





ROUTE MARKER

Purpose: Outdoor directional sign guiding visitors to key heritage landmarks within the Zeytin lik / Templos area while maintaining a natural and premium village identity.



Materials:

1) Solid hardwood directional panels with weather-resis-tant coating.
2) Powder-coated steel support post in dark bronze finish.
3) CNC engraved lettering filled with dark charcoal colour
Integrated directional arrows engraved into the wood surface.

Destinations

- Writers' Park and Templos Stone Park
- Ancient Olive Tree
- Zeytinlik Muhtarligi

Location:

1)L02 – Stone Park2)
2)L-03 Tree park near the Ancient Olive Tree





ROUTE MARKER

Purpose: Vertical wayfinding totem designed to guide visitors within the Zeytinlik heritage district. The marker provides clear walking directions and approximate distances to nearby cultural landmarks while maintaining a cohesive village identity and visual consistency throughout the heritage route.

Materials:

1) Solid hardwood vertical panel with weath-er-resistant protective coating.
2) Powder-coated steel mounting system integrated onto existing lighting poles or standalone posts.
3) CNC engraved directional arrows and destination names filled with dark charcoal pigment for maximum readability.

Destinations

- Rest Café -5 m
- Cyprus Village House - 10 m
- Templos Homes - 20 m

Location:

1) L-04 zone (Well area)
2) K-03 zone (Zeytinlik Muhtarligi area)



